

User Guide: Buyer

This guide explains how to use the platform as a **Buyer**: browsing the marketplace, placing and managing orders, arranging delivery or collection, and rating farmers.

1. Logging in

1. Open the platform in your browser and go to **Login**.
2. Enter your **phone** (or email) and **password**.
3. Click **Sign in**. You are taken to **Marketplace** or **My Dashboard**; the sidebar shows the buyer menu.

2. Main menu and navigation

After login, the sidebar shows:

Menu item	Path / Purpose
Marketplace	Browse produce listings and place orders
My Orders	View and manage all your orders
Bulk Requests	Create and manage bulk/recurring sourcing requests
Deliveries	Track and manage delivery status
Collection	Confirm collection or receiving of orders
Rate Farmers	Rate farmers after completed orders
Analytics	View procurement and spending metrics

Use the **menu icon** on small screens to open or close the sidebar.

3. Browsing and ordering from the marketplace

Essence: The **Marketplace** is where you **discover and buy produce** from farmers: variety, grade, quantity, price, and location. You can order from **active** listings straight away, including **advance orders** on produce that will be ready later—so you secure supply in one place and the order is fulfilled when the crop is ready.

Flow: **Browse listings** → **Select listing** → **Place order** → **Farmer accepts** → **Pay (if escrow)** → **Fulfilment** → **Collect/Deliver** → **Rate**.

1. Go to **Marketplace** in the sidebar.
2. You see **produce listings** as cards or rows: variety, grade, quantity, price per kg, location, and **expected ready date**. Listings with a **future** ready date show an **advance order** label: you can order now; they are fulfilled when the produce is ready.
3. Use **filters** (e.g. variety, grade, location) and **search** to find what you need.
4. Click a listing to open **full details**: farmer info, location (county, ward, etc.), expected ready date, optional images, and available quantity.
5. Click **Order** (or **Place order**). In the form, enter:
 - **Quantity** (within available quantity)
 - **Delivery/collection preferences** if asked (e.g. delivery address, or collection point)
6. Submit. The order is created and appears in **My Orders** with status **Order placed**.
7. The **farmer** can **Accept** or **Reject** the order. You may get a **notification** when they respond. If they reject, you may see a reason; the order will not proceed.
8. If accepted, you may be prompted to **pay** (e.g. into escrow). Complete payment as shown on the order page or in the payment dialog. Until payment is done (if required), the order may stay in a “payment pending” state.
9. When the produce is ready, the order status may move to **Ready for collection** or **In delivery**. You (or your transport provider) **collect** at the agreed point or **receive delivery**; then the order is marked **Collected** or **Delivered** (you may need to **Confirm delivery** or **Confirm collection** from My Orders or the Collection/Deliveries screens).
10. After delivery/collection you can **rate the farmer** from **My Orders** (open the order → Rate farmer) or from **Rate Farmers**.

Advance orders appear in **My Orders** as soon as you place them; fulfilment happens when the produce is ready and the centre/farmer updates status.

4. My Orders

Essence: My Orders is your **purchasing hub**: every order you place (including advance orders) appears here. You can pay, track status, confirm delivery or collection, view traceability, and rate the farmer—so you manage the full order lifecycle in one place.

Flow: Open Orders → Filter/search → Open order → Pay / Confirm delivery or collection / Rate farmer.

1. Go to **My Orders** in the sidebar.
2. You see **all your orders** in a list or table (including advance orders on listings not yet ready). Each row typically shows order number, farmer, variety, quantity, price, status, and date.
3. Use **status filter** (e.g. All, Order placed, Accepted, Ready for collection, Delivered) and **search** (e.g. by order number or variety) to find orders.
4. Click an order to open **Order details**. You see:
 - **Farmer** name and contact
 - **Listing** (variety, grade, quantity)
 - **Price** and total
 - **Status** (Order placed, Accepted, Payment pending, Ready for collection, In delivery, Collected, Delivered, etc.)
 - **Payment and escrow** (if applicable): pay here if payment is pending
 - **Delivery/collection** info and buttons: **Confirm delivery** or **Confirm collection** when you have received the produce
 - **Traceability**: view batch or traceability info if available
 - **Rate farmer**: after the order is completed, submit a rating and optional comment
5. From the order you can:
 - **Pay** (if payment is pending)—follow the payment dialog or link
 - **Confirm delivery** or **Confirm collection** once you have received the produce—this updates the order and allows you to rate
 - **View traceability** (e.g. batch info) if the option is shown
 - **Rate farmer** for completed orders

Orders stay in **My Orders** in all statuses so you can track them from placement to completion.

5. Bulk requests (recurring / sourcing requests)

Essence: Bulk Requests lets you **state ongoing or large-volume needs** (e.g. regular supply of a variety/grade). Suppliers or the platform can respond with offers or orders, so you secure steady supply without repeating one-off marketplace orders each time.

Flow: Create request → Set requirements → Submit → View offers/orders → Accept and manage.

1. Go to **Bulk Requests** (or **Recurring orders / Sourcing requests**) in the sidebar.
2. Click **Create** (or **New request**) and fill in your requirements, for example:
 - **Quantity** and unit (e.g. kg per week or total)
 - **Variety** and **grade**
 - **Frequency** (e.g. weekly, monthly) if recurring
 - **Location or delivery** preferences if applicable
3. Submit. The request is created and may be visible to suppliers or the platform for matching.
4. View **existing requests** in the same section. Open a request to see any **offers** or **orders** linked to it. Accept offers or place orders as the flow allows, and manage follow-up from this screen.

6. Deliveries

Essence: Deliveries shows orders **on the way** to you. You track status (e.g. in transit, out for delivery) and **confirm delivery** when produce is received—so the order is closed correctly and you can rate the farmer.

Flow: Open Deliveries → See in-transit orders → When produce arrives, confirm delivery.

1. Go to **Deliveries** in the sidebar.
2. You see orders that are **in delivery** or scheduled for delivery (e.g. status “In delivery” or “Out for delivery”). The list may show order number, farmer, destination, and status.
3. Track status as the delivery progresses. When the produce **arrives**, open the order and click **Confirm delivery** (or equivalent). This updates the order to **Delivered** and allows you to **rate the farmer** from **My Orders** or **Rate Farmers**.

If no orders are in delivery, the list may be empty; use **My Orders** to see all orders and their status.

7. Collection (collection receiving)

Essence: **Collection** is for orders you **collect in person** (e.g. at an aggregation centre or pickup point). You see what's ready for collection and **confirm collection** once you have received the produce—so the order completes and you can rate the farmer.

Flow: **Open Collection** → **See orders ready for collection** → **Collect produce** → **Confirm collection**.

1. Go to **Collection** in the sidebar.
2. You see orders that are **ready for collection** or that you need to confirm as received at a collection point. The list may show order number, farmer, collection point, and status.
3. Go to the collection point and receive the produce. When you have it, open the order and click **Confirm collection** (or equivalent). The order status updates (e.g. to **Collected**) and you can **rate the farmer** from **My Orders** or **Rate Farmers**.

If nothing is ready for collection, the list may be empty; check **My Orders** and filter by status.

8. Rate Farmers

Essence: **Rate Farmers** lets you **give feedback** after a completed order. Your ratings help other buyers and the platform understand supplier quality, and they encourage good practice—so the marketplace stays trustworthy.

Flow: **Open Rate Farmers or My Orders** → **Select completed order** → **Submit rating (and optional comment)**.

1. Go to **Rate Farmers** in the sidebar.
2. You see **completed orders** with farmers you have not yet rated (or a list of farmers with pending ratings). The page may group by farmer or by order.
3. Select an order (or farmer) and open the rating form. Enter:
 - **Rating** (e.g. stars or score)
 - **Comment** (optional)
4. Submit. The rating is saved and may be shown to other buyers or used in supplier summaries.
5. You can also **rate from My Orders**: open a **completed** order (e.g. Delivered or Collected) and use the **Rate farmer** button there to submit the same rating.

Once rated, that order may no longer appear in the “pending rating” list.

9. Analytics

Essence: **Analytics** gives you a **view of your procurement**: spend, order counts, suppliers, deliveries, and trends over time. Use it to see where you buy, how much you spend, and how delivery and collection are performing.

Flow: **Open Analytics** → **View metrics and charts** → **Use date filters if needed**.

1. Go to **Analytics** (or **My Dashboard**) in the sidebar.
2. View **procurement metrics**, for example:
 - Total spend and order count
 - Number of suppliers (farmers) you’ve bought from
 - Deliveries or collections over a period
 - Trends (e.g. by week or month)
3. Use **date filters** (e.g. date range) if available to focus on a specific period. Export or print if the page supports it.

10. Notifications and profile

- **Notifications** (bell icon or in-app) can alert you when a farmer **accepts or rejects** your order, when an order is **ready for collection**, or when **delivery** is updated. Open a notification to go to the relevant order or screen.
- Use **Settings** or **Profile** (if available in the header) to update your details, delivery addresses, or password.

11. Quick reference: key flows

Goal	Steps
Buy produce	Marketplace → Choose listing → Place order → Wait for farmer acceptance → Pay if required → Collect/Deliver → Confirm delivery or collection → Rate
Track orders	My Orders → Filter by status → Open order for details, payment, or delivery confirmation

Goal	Steps
Bulk/recurring	Bulk Requests → Create request → Manage offers and orders
Receive delivery	Deliveries → Find order → When produce arrives → Confirm delivery
Collect in person	Collection → Find order → Collect produce → Confirm collection
Rate farmer	Rate Farmers or My Orders → Select completed order → Submit rating and optional comment

For the **farmers'** perspective (posting listings, accepting orders), see [User Guide: Farmer](#).